

The Monograph System

One place where a department manages every final-year monograph: from the first idea a student writes down, to the day the finished work is defended, graded and shelved in the archive.

This explains what you do in it, whoever you are.

Students — propose a topic, upload work, read feedback

Supervisors — review submissions and guide students

Heads of department — approve topics, assign supervisors, run defences

Committee members — examine monographs and enter scores

Administrators — accounts, academic years, department rules

BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

Signing in

Go to the address your department gave you. Everyone uses the same page.

USERNAME

Your university ID

Students use their student number, staff their staff number. Never an email address.

PASSWORD

From the administrator

The system sends no email, so there is no reset link. Ask them directly if you forget it.

ONCE YOU ARE IN

Three controls, top right

The moon or sun switches light and dark. The bell shows what is new. Your name opens your profile and sign out.

Two people on one computer? Open a second browser tab. Each tab holds its own login, so a supervisor and a student can work side by side. Closing a tab ends that tab's session, which is what you want on a shared machine.

THE SPINE OF EVERYTHING

How a monograph travels

Thirteen stages, always in this order. A monograph cannot skip one, and it cannot move backwards without a reason being written down.

Whoever is named beside a stage is the only person who can move it on from there.

- 1 **Draft**
Student writes the idea down. Nothing is official and every word can still change.
 - 2 **Topic submitted**
Student sends it to the department. It locks now. *Needs a title and a research area.*
 - 3 **Topic approved**
Head of Dept accepts the topic and the student learns who will supervise them. *Needs a supervisor assigned first.*
 - 4 **Proposal submitted**
Student writes the full proposal and sends it to their supervisor. *Needs the proposal file uploaded.*
 - 5 **Under review**
Supervisor is reading it. The student can see that, instead of wondering.
 - 6 **Revision required**
Supervisor sends it back with corrections. *Needs a written explanation.*
- This is a loop.** The student fixes the work and submits again, which returns it to stage 4. It can go round as many times as the work needs, and every round is kept: round one and round two both stay readable years later.
- 7 **Proposal approved**
Supervisor is satisfied. The research may begin.
 - 8 **Research in progress**
Student does the work and uploads chapters as they are finished. Each chapter can be reviewed the same way the proposal was.
 - 9 **Final submission**
Student uploads the complete monograph. *Needs the final file uploaded.*
 - 10 **Final review**
Supervisor reads the whole work and decides whether it is ready to defend. If not, it goes back to stage 8.
 - 11 **Defence scheduled**
Head of Dept sets the date and place and appoints the committee. Everyone is notified. *Needs a full committee.*

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Defended

Head of Dept closes the defence once every examiner has entered a score. *Needs all scores in.*

13

Completed

Head of Dept records the grade and the monograph joins the department's permanent archive.
Needs a final grade.

Rejected

The work cannot continue in this form. Only the head of department can do this, and only with a written reason.

Withdrawn

The student steps away from the topic. Available up until a defence is scheduled, again only with a written reason.

FOR STUDENTS

What you do

Your first screen answers one question: where am I? A ring shows how far you have come, and a track marks the stage you are standing on.

Propose your topic

[Monographs → Propose a topic](#)

Fill in a working title, choose a research area, and describe what you want to do. It saves as a **draft**, and a draft is yours alone: you can change every word.

When you are ready, open your monograph and choose **Topic submitted for approval**. Only then does the department see it, and only then does it lock.

Upload your work

[Open monograph → Documents → Upload a file](#)

Say what the file is, pick it, and upload. For a chapter, give its number.

Uploading again never replaces anything. Your second upload becomes version 2 and version 1 stays exactly where it was. Write a line in *What changed?* — your supervisor sees it and it saves them re-reading the whole thing.

Read your feedback

[Open monograph → Feedback](#)

Every review you have ever been given, oldest first, so the sequence reads like a conversation.

Where your supervisor pinned a correction to a page, you can **tick it off** as you deal with it. They can see what you have done.

Move forward

The buttons on your monograph are exactly the moves you can make right now. If a button you expect is missing, something is not ready — usually a file you have not uploaded, or your supervisor has not answered yet.

The system tells you which when you try, in a sentence, not an error code.

Your defence

Once your supervisor accepts your final monograph, the head of department sets a date and appoints examiners. It appears on your first screen and the bell tells you. Afterwards you see your result and your final grade.

FOR SUPERVISORS

What you do

Your first screen answers a different question: what needs me today? It lists students waiting on you, longest wait first, because that is the fairest order to work through them.

See what is waiting [Dashboard, or Reviews](#)

The dashboard also flags students who have **gone quiet** — no progress for a month or more. That is usually the more urgent problem, because nobody else is watching for it.

Review a submission [Open monograph → Feedback → Write a review](#)

Pick one of three answers:

Approve

The work is satisfactory. The monograph moves on by itself.

Request revisions

Say what must change. The system will not let you send this without an explanation.

Reject

The work cannot continue in this form. Also requires a reason.

Add **specific corrections** pinned to a page wherever you can. A numbered list is far easier for a student to work through than a paragraph, and you can see which ones they have dealt with.

A review is permanent. Nothing in the system can edit or delete it afterwards — not you, not the head of department, not the administrator. That protects you as much as the student.

Check whether corrections were applied [Documents → expand a document](#)

Any document with more than one version can be compared. You see both versions, what the student said they changed, and the feedback you gave between them — so you need not remember what you asked for six weeks ago.

Approve a chapter on its own

You can accept chapter two while the work as a whole is still in progress. If the student later uploads a correction to an approved document, the approval is withdrawn automatically. It is a different file now.

FOR HEADS OF DEPARTMENT

What you do

Your first screen answers the questions that used to mean ringing every supervisor one by one.

The department at a glance [Dashboard](#)

- How many students are working, and how many have finished.
 - How many submissions are sitting unanswered past your agreed response time.
 - How many students have gone quiet.
 - How loaded each supervisor is. Red means over their limit.
 - Where monographs spend the most time, which shows the real bottleneck rather than the assumed one.
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Assign a supervisor [Open monograph → Assign supervisor](#)

Each person's current load sits beside their name, so you can spread the work. Anyone already at their limit is marked.

You **can** still choose someone at capacity — sometimes there is no one else — and the dashboard will show it in red so it is not quietly forgotten.

Approve a topic [Open monograph → Topic approved](#)

The system will refuse until a supervisor is assigned. That is deliberate: an approved topic with nobody guiding it goes nowhere. So assign first, then approve.

If the topic is unsuitable, send it back with an explanation and the student can change it.

Schedule a defence [Defenses → Schedule a defence](#)

Set the date, time and place, then name the committee and each person's role. Your department's rules set the minimum committee size and the system will not accept fewer. Everyone involved is notified at once.

Record the result [Open the defence → Record the result](#)

Each examiner enters their own score; nobody can enter one for somebody else. Once every score is in, you record the outcome.

The final grade is calculated from **your department's own weights**. The result itself is whatever the committee decided — the arithmetic never overrules the people in the room.

Print official forms

[Open monograph → Forms](#)

- Topic approval form
- Supervisor assignment letter
- Defence notice
- Defence result sheet

Each comes out with signature lines and room for the department stamp. A form only becomes available once the information it carries actually exists, so nobody prints a result sheet for a defence that has not happened.

Reports

[Reports](#)

Progress for the year, supervisor workload, where time is being lost, and everyone behind schedule.

Export as CSV gives you a spreadsheet for the faculty.

Your department's rules

[Settings](#)

Everything that differs between departments lives here: who approves topics, how supervisors are chosen, how many students one supervisor may carry, committee size, how the grade is weighted, and how long is too long before the system raises the alarm.

Confirm these with your faculty before changing them. The two grade weights must add up to 100, and the system will refuse to save if they do not.

FOR COMMITTEE MEMBERS

What you do

Your first screen lists the monographs you have been asked to examine, with the date of each defence.

Before the defence

Open the monograph, read it, then mark **I have read it**. The head of department can then see who is prepared, before the day rather than on it.

After the defence

[Open the defence → Enter my score](#)

Enter your score out of 100 and any comments. You can change your own score right up until the result is recorded, and no one else can enter a score on your behalf.

FOR ADMINISTRATORS

What you do

You keep the accounts and the calendar in order. Almost everything else looks after itself.

Set the department up, once

[The admin site, at /admin/](#)

Order matters, because each step depends on the one before it:

1. **Faculty** — name and a short code.
 2. **Department** — its rules are on the same page. Confirm them with the real head of department before anyone starts.
 3. **Academic year** — add it and mark it current.
 4. **Research areas** — the subjects the department supervises. Without at least one, no student can submit a topic.
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Add people

[People → Add a person](#)

Set their university ID, name, role and department. Students also need a student ID. Email is optional and is never needed to sign in.

The department is not optional. An account without one cannot propose, supervise or approve anything, because all of those are scoped to a department — and nothing on screen would explain why.

Reset a password

[People → the key icon](#)

Set a new one and tell the person directly. The system sends no email, by design: many students do not use it.

Never delete an account

Deactivate it instead. A graduated student's name must still appear on their archived monograph. Deactivating stops them signing in and changes nothing else.

The archive

[Archive](#)

Finished monographs arrive here on their own. Anyone signed in can search by title, author, supervisor or keyword. This is what future students read instead of starting from nothing every year.

ASKED OFTEN

Questions

Why can I not press a button I expect?

Something is not ready. Usually a file has not been uploaded, or a supervisor has not been assigned. The system names the missing piece when you try.

I uploaded the wrong file.

Upload the right one. It becomes a new version, and the wrong one stays in the history rather than pretending it never happened.

Can I delete something?

No, and that is the point. Nothing is ever removed, which is what makes the record worth trusting for everybody — including you.

Can two students write one monograph together?

If your department allows it. It is one of the settings a head of department controls, so ask them.

The page is not updating.

It usually updates by itself as other people act. On a weak connection, reload the page — nothing is lost.

I cannot see another student's monograph.

You are not meant to. Student work is private to the student, their supervisor, the head of department and their defence committee. To anyone else it does not appear to exist at all.

FOR REFERENCE

The rules your department sets

These are the settings that differ between departments. The values shown are the starting points; a head of department confirms and changes them in Settings.

RULE	STARTS AT	WHAT IT GOVERNS
Committee size	3	A defence cannot be scheduled with fewer members.
Grade weighting	40 / 60	Supervisor's mark, then the committee average. Must total 100.
Passing grade	60	Below this, the suggested result is a fail.
Students per supervisor	10	An individual limit can be set on a supervisor's own profile.
Supervisor response time	7 days	Work waiting longer is flagged on the dashboard.
Student inactivity	30 days	No progress for this long and the student is flagged as gone quiet.
Duplicate topic threshold	60%	Topics scoring above this against past work are flagged for the head.
Group monographs	Allowed	Whether two students may share one monograph, and how many at most.

Everything a student submits is kept, and every action is recorded with who did it and when, in a history that nothing in the system can rewrite. That is the quiet point of all of it: arguments about whether work was handed in on time, or whether corrections were ever given, simply end. The record is there, and both sides can read it.